www.rbwm.gov.uk

Royal Borough of Windsor & Maidenhead

Branding Book



September 2025

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Foreword

We are proud of the image our council projects in both its hard-working colleagues and the materials that are published making our brand identity paramount to the work we do.

This document outlines how the corporate brand should be used across everything that the council produces, from letterheads, to posters to signage. This isn't about rebranding the council. We want consistency and quality in the application of the brand across everything that we do. Our logo remains the same but has been updated and modernised.

So, why is our brand important?

It's important to us because it sets an expectation for how our residents and partners will perceive the council. If our printed materials, digital communications, stationery and signage look consistent and professional, then people will perceive us in that way.

Clear branding promotes accountability - if all our services are clearly branded as the Royal Borough of Windsor & Maidenhead, then our residents will know what we are providing for them and how their money is being spent.

The guidelines support the effective marketing of our services and assets. Consistent branding isn't about everything looking exactly the same, but ensuring that we promote our services to our residents. This is an organisation with different services with different needs and there is unique branding for certain teams.

As such we expect everyone in the organisation to adhere to these guidelines in any designed work. We also expect everyone in the organisation to adhere to these in any designed work that they commission. A brand isn't just about a logo – it's a whole look and feel that should reflect the values of an organisation. This is about the kind of organisation we are and that we want to be: professional, forward-looking, creative and unified. The Royal Borough of Windsor & Maidenhead brand should be owned by the whole organisation. Please come and talk to us if you have any questions or suggestions about how we can develop this further in the future.

Visual identity

Introduction

Our brand is the collective impact or lasting impression from all that is seen, heard, or experienced by those who come into contact with the council and its activities and services. Therefore, a brand is more than just a logo. However, a logo is a point of identification – the symbol that customers use to instantly recognise a brand.

Ideally, we want people to instantly connect the sight of our logo with the memory of what we do – and, more importantly, how it makes them feel. Leaflets, publications, letters, signs, vehicles and adverts all give people an impression of the Royal Borough of Windsor & Maidenhead. That is why it is so crucial to have a professional brand that is used consistently and effectively so that people's first impression of us is a positive one.

This assists ensuring authenticity – so people can trust that what they are seeing is from the council, helping to also combat fraud. It is important that we are consistent with our logo – its appearance and where it is positioned. This helps to create a 'brand identity', which means that people should be able to recognise instantly that something has been produced by the council or is a service delivered by the council. Branding everything that we do consistently helps people to understand the different services we provide.

The council's logo consists of the borough crest, granted when the council was created, and the words 'Royal Borough of Windsor & Maidenhead'. This Branding Book outlines how the council's logo should be used to ensure it keeps its recognition and authority, as well as outlining the other related brands for the ceremonial use and Visit Windsor.

Logo

There are two layouts of the Royal Borough logo:

- portrait
- landscape

Portrait

This logo is available in either monochrome (preferred version) or colour (purple) with a transparent background and must be used on all council publications. Please refer to the section in this guide on placement of the logo for further information on correct positioning.

If you require a white background on the logo to avoid design clashes with the background an alternative version with a dark border and solid background is also available. Please note the guidance for placement and size should be done for the edges of the logo and not the square border to keep the logo the same size through all published content.

Landscape

This logo is for use on the Royal Borough of Windsor & Maidenhead website. Additional use of this logo elsewhere is restricted and will require permission from the Communications team.

Please note - if you want to use a monochrome version of the logo you must obtain a copy from the Communications team and not alter the colours yourself.

Portrait:



Landscape:



Civic and ceremonial

The borough's royal status and its high profile ceremonial, civic and mayoral events have enabled us to retain the Royal Crest element of the logo for special ceremonies and for important elements of the council year.

This means there is a distinctive ceremonial version of the logo which is used for specific events, including:

- Civic services
- Mayor-making
- The Mayor's annual charity events

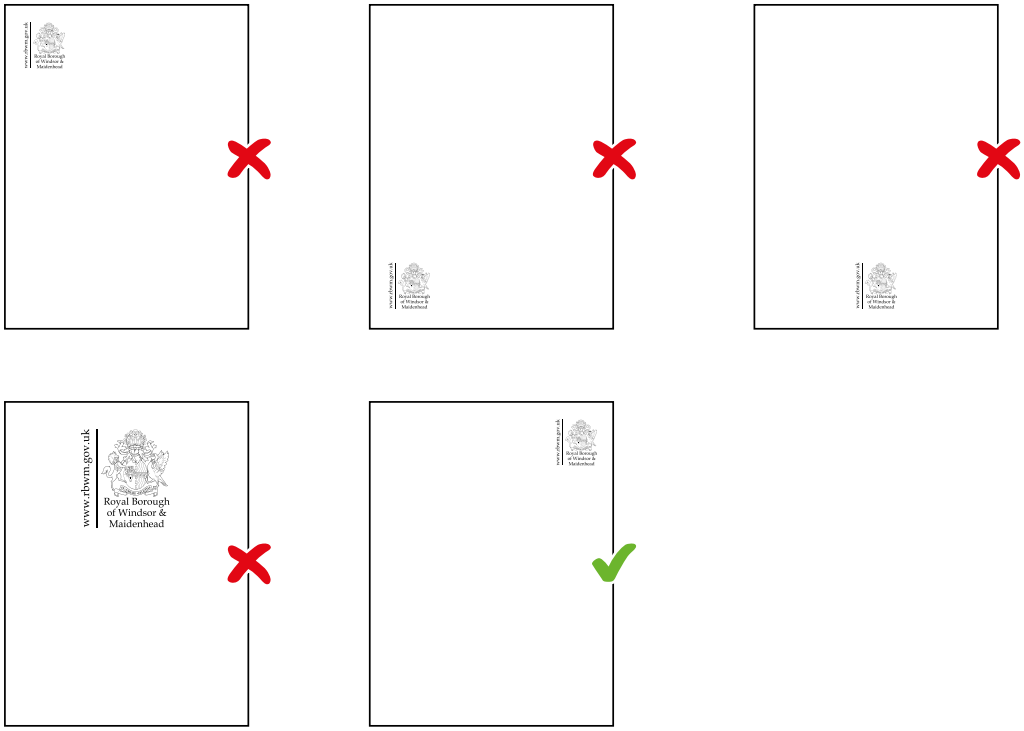
In addition the Royal Crest is also permitted to be used for livery under the supervision of the Communications team.

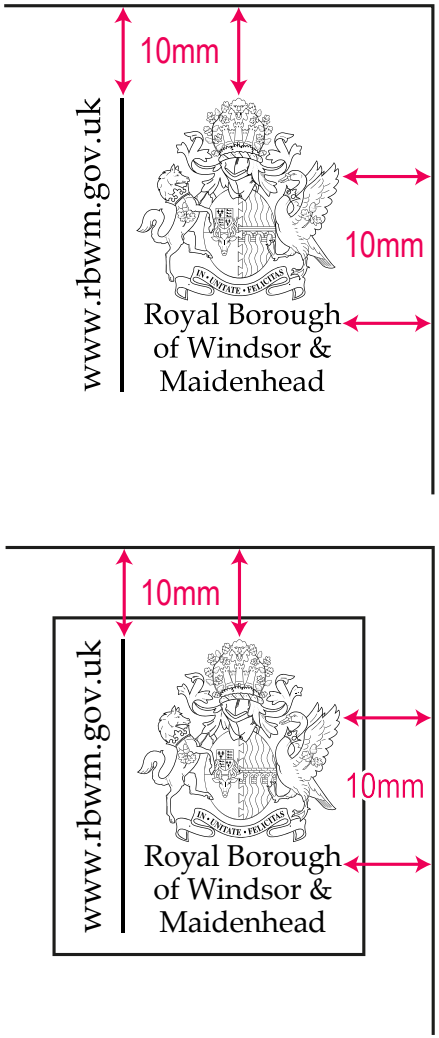
The ceremonial logo must NOT be used for other council purposes.



Placement of logo (portrait)

You are required to place the logo in the top right corner. The logo must not be placed elsewhere without approval from the Communications team. There should be a space of 10mm from the logo edges and the top/ bottom and right edge of the page





Size of logo (portrait)

To ensure the clarity and visibility of the logo it should never be used smaller than 20mm wide.

The minimum recommended logo width measurement for paper sizes is as follows:

- 20mm for a one-third of A4 document (DL)
- 20mm on an A6 document (105 x 148 mm)
- 25mm on an A5 document (148 x 210 mm)
- 31mm on an A4 document (210 x 297 mm)

The logo can be increased in size as appropriate for larger documents. If the version of the logo with the additional border and background is being used the same measurements above apply but should be made to the edge of the crest and not the border so the crest remains the same size as the transparent version.

For items smaller than A6, for example, library tickets and Advantage Cards, the logo may be used in smaller versions, appropriate to the dimensions of the surface on which it is to be applied. The logo must remain clear and visible, irrespective of size.

Placement of logo (landscape)

Please note usage of the landscape logo is restricted and will require approval from the Communications team which will include placement instructions given on an individual basis.

Colleagues are not permitted to share a copy of the landscape logo either internally or externally.

An exclusive design of the landscape logo is also used by www.windsor.gov.uk and must not be reproduced by other teams without the consent of the Communications team.



Logo protection and unacceptable use

Under no circumstances is anyone allowed to manipulate the shape or details of the logo as shown in the given examples below:



When resizing the logo it is important that you resize it in proportion and never stretch or distort it as these examples show. On microsoft office applications if you hold SHIFT + click and drag the corner this will keep the graphic in proportion.

The Royal Borough logo has been created as our unique mark and it must NEVER be redrawn, altered or corrupted in any way.

To ensure the integrity of the logo please do not:

- Generate the logo using software on your PC
- Download the logo from the internet
- Scan the logo from other publications
- Use ‘artistic licence’ on the logo for individual design purposes, other than with permission from the Communications team.

Please remember: The logo must not be altered or varied wherever it is used. This is to ensure the logo remains consistent and intact irrespective of the medium on which it is carried.

Note for external designers

Logos must be obtained from the Communications team and not taken from any other external sources for example, the Royal Borough website or other documentation containing the borough logo.

Stretching or any kind of amendment to the logo is not permitted. For placement of the logo please refer to the rest of the Visual Identity section of this guide.

Please email communications@rbwm.gov.uk for all enquiries regarding use of the Royal Borough logo.



Corporate colours

This is the agreed colour palette and tones to be used for all corporate materials. For additional agreed colour schemes please refer to the additional branding section of this guide.

Other colours are permitted in design but it is preferential to incorporate the corporate gold and purple colours when creating graphic elements to be recognised. Exceptions are given though when there is a design clash with other colours.







The examples here make reference to the primary colours and tints, enforcing a recognised brand by colour.

Primary corporate colours

PANTONE SOLID COATED: 259 C

RAL: 4008 'SIGNAL VIOLET'

CMYK: 69, 100, 12, 3
RGB: 113, 33, 119
HEX: # 6F2277

PANTONE SOLID COATED: 7503 C

RAL: 1001 'BEIGE'

CMYK: 31, 32, 62, 14
RGB: 171, 151, 103
HEX: # AA9767

Secondary colours

While the primary palette is intentionally limited, not everything can be achieved using only purple and gold. The secondary colour palette provides a wider range of colours that represent the council aims and help differentiate the breadth of services the council delivers. These colours are particularly useful for applications such as data visualisations, social media graphics, and video content.

Aim 1: Put the council on a strong financial footing to serve the borough effectively

HEX: # 5CB8B8

Aim 2: A cleaner, greener, safer and more prosperous borough

HEX: # 74B55B

Aim 3: Children and young people have a good start in life and opportunities through to adulthood

HEX: # DE7E00

Aim 4: People live healthy and independent lives in supportive communities

HEX: # 597DB3

Aim 5: A high-performing council that delivers for the borough

HEX: # 8D3E93

Imagery

The council is developing a library of approved quality images for colleagues to use in publications to reinforce recognition of the Royal Borough brand.

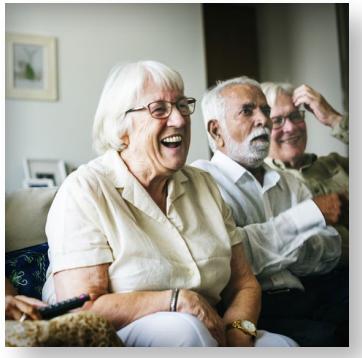
Images of people should attempt to accurately reflect the Royal Borough's demographic as well as the audience you are trying to engage with. All images of people used need to be of a high quality and well lit (avoid strong shadows). The council does allow the use of stock photographs of people providing they have appropriate relevance.

Abstract images can be used providing they assist in suggesting the relevant concepts the publication is trying to convey for example, nature, the environment, choices. It's important when selecting an abstract image to use that you consider what words are associated with it as well as the emotional reaction it may invoke in the viewing audience.

For all image enquiries please email communications@rbwm.gov.uk



















Email formatting and signatures

For a technical guide on how to add or change your email signature click here. All council emails should be composed in Arial 12 (regular) in black. The format for email signatures is below:

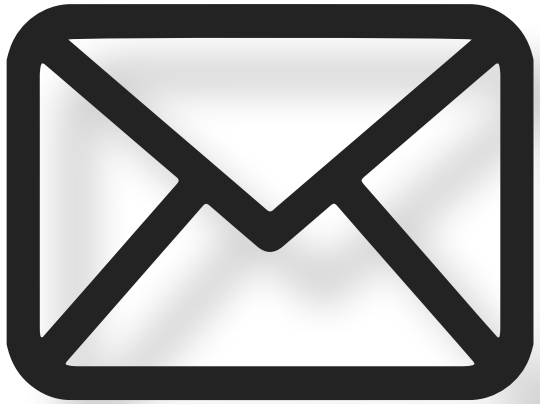
Kind regards,

www.rbwm.gov.uk
Royal Borough of Windsor & Maidenhead

Name in bold (preferred pronouns - optional)
Job Title
Team Name
Directorate
Royal Borough of Windsor & Maidenhead
Town Hall, St Ives Road, Maidenhead SL6 1RF

Tel: XXXXX XXXXXX
Mobile: XXXXX XXXXXX (optional)

Website: www.rbwm.gov.uk
Follow us on Twitter: @RBWM
Like us on Facebook



To download the template to copy and paste into your outlook signature click here

If you wish to include additional graphics or messages in your email signature you will need to contact communications@rbwm.gov.uk for approval.

Microsoft Teams backgrounds

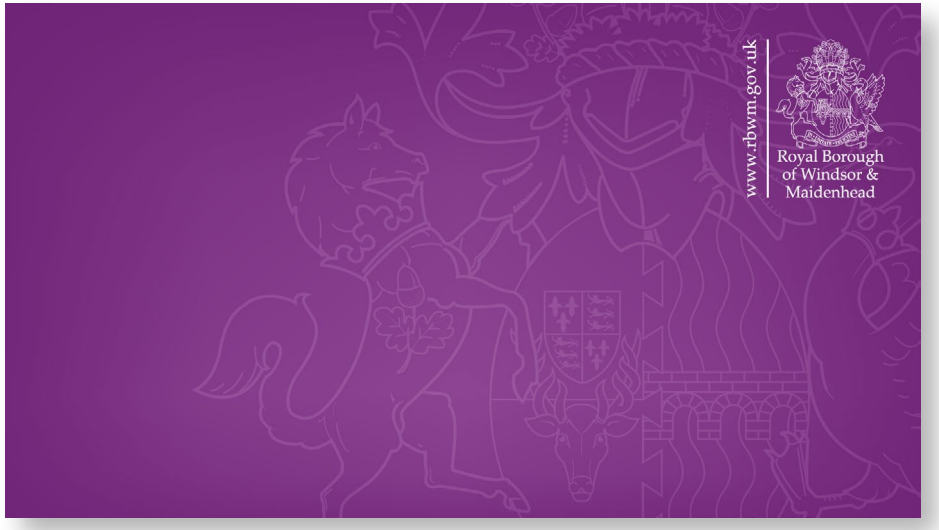
A person's webcam background during meetings plays an important role in projecting professionalism and creating a distraction-free environment. It also provides an opportunity for consistent branding and representation, helps protect privacy and confidentiality and contributes to a clean, professional visual aesthetic.

The council has provided two approved background templates for colleagues to use during Microsoft Teams meetings. To download the backgrounds from SharePoint, please click here.

Official guidance on how to change your background image in Microsoft Teams can be found here.

Please note: when previewing your background in Teams, the logo may appear reversed if your camera preview is set to "mirrored" under video settings (this is enabled by default). Other participants will see the background the correct way round during the live call.







Accessibility

Introduction

It is important that council officers are aware of the specific needs and requirements of the audiences they are trying to reach for both online and printed content. This is vital to providing information which is both relevant and targeted instead of producing a generic piece which attempts to cater to everyone. You are expected to highlight any specific audiences who may struggle to understand or read information, possibly due to a disability or not having English as a first language. When looking at producing accessible content the following items need careful consideration:

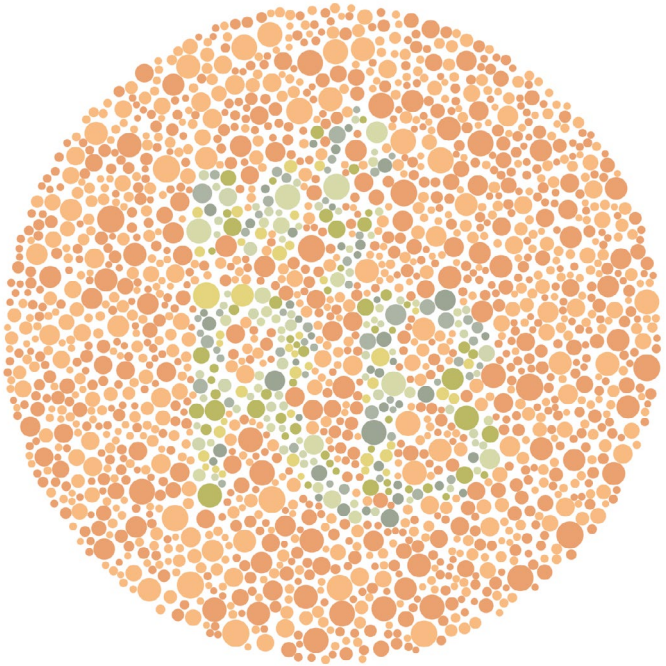
1. How we use fonts
2. Number of images used and placement
3. Readability and colour
4. Spacing and alignment.

'branding' in braille

Colour vision deficiency

Colour vision deficiency (CVD) affects one in 12 males and one in 200 females. It is important when producing any publications that the messages being displayed are in a format which can be easily read and not restricted by CVD.

For further information please visit
www.colourblindawareness.org





Red blind / protanopia



Monochromacy / achromatopsia



Blue-blind / tritanopia

Readability and colour

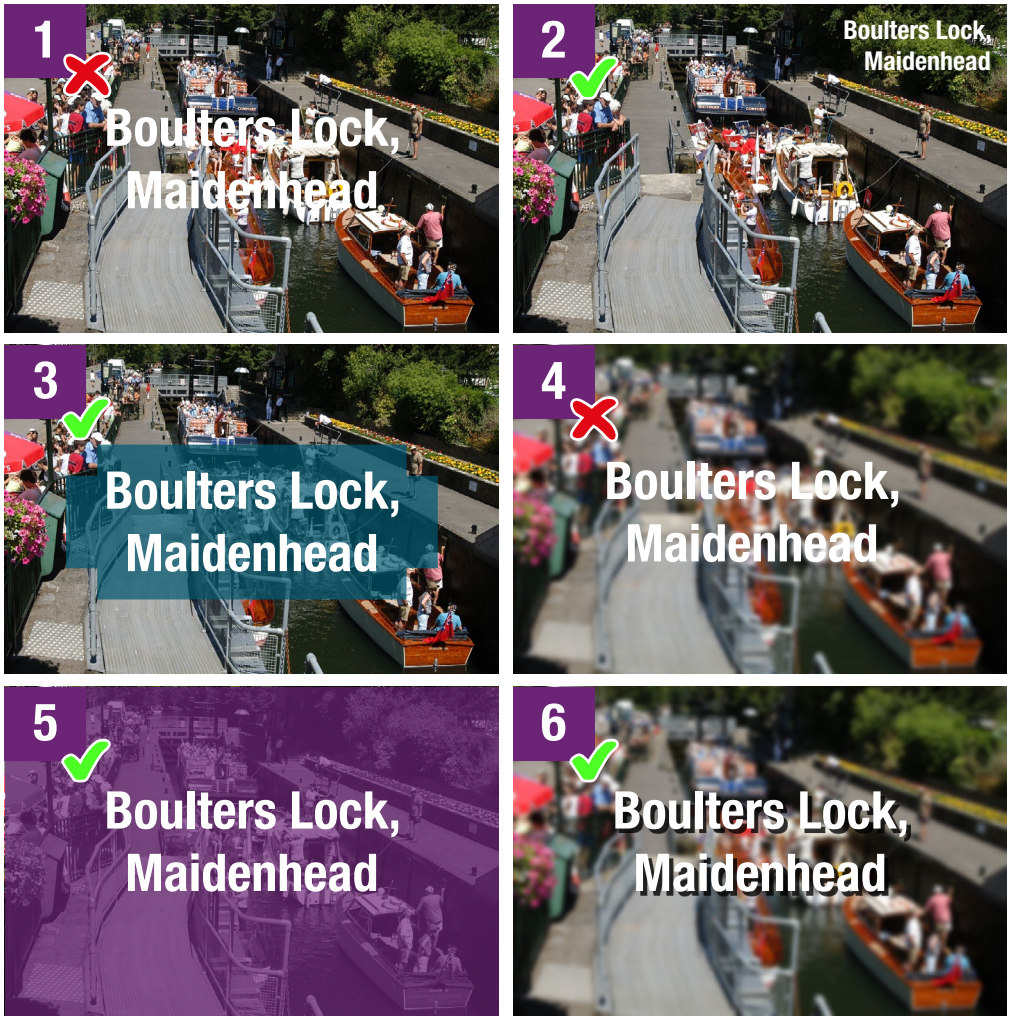
We understand the importance when producing designed content that the text can be read against any design elements situated directly underneath.

Creating contrast between text and any underlying graphic element helps ensure legibility and is often something which is overlooked. When text is combined with an image we ensure the font varies in colour enough to be seen in combination with the image. For example, if there is a photo with a dark background, a white (or light-coloured) text is preferred. If the photo has a light background, the preference would be a dark-coloured type treatment.

Contrast can also refer to the size of text in relationship to what is happening in the image. Lettering should work with, not against, the image.

When the background contains many colours or differences between light and dark sections, putting text inside another frame can really make it stand out. A shape that works with the word choices and image too. Also a colour for the box that provides enough contrast for the lettering to show. Using a frame with some transparency for a softer feel that allows the image to show through.

The following examples show:



1. the text clashes too much with the image
2. the text has been resized and repositioned to fit better with the image; however it doesn't stand out as much
3. the coloured box has been added under the text to provide contrast but also has been made transparent to allow the background image to show through
4. blurring the background brings it out of focus, making the overlaying text stand out, although is still slightly too difficult to read
5. an overlaying colour provides contrast against the title while still showing the image behind
6. a drop shadow effect makes the title stand out better when applied to the previously blurred background. Without both effects the busy nature of the background would still clash.

Fonts

There are several agreed fonts to be used in all council materials. Any use of fonts which go beyond this scope will require approval from the Communications team before publication.

Please also refer to the accessibility section in this guide for additional advice on use of fonts and readability.

Arial — This typeface should be used in most situations. The face exists in multiple weights to accommodate many uses. When using Microsoft Office applications this is the preferred font.

Palatino Linotype — This font has been selected to be used in publications that require a more traditional approach and is also the typeface used for the Royal Borough of Windsor & Maidenhead logo.

Arial (sans-serif font)

abcdefghijklmn
opqrstuvwxyz
1234567890

Palatino Linotype (serif font)

abcdefghijklmn
opqrstuvwxyz
1234567890

Arial Rounded MT — This font has been selected to be used in publications that require a softer or less business-like approach, such as material targeted at families and children.

Helvetica Nue LT Standard — This licensed font family is used primarily in the council's materials designed by the Communications team who hold the individual licenses.

Arial Rounded MT (Bold)

abcdefghijklmn
opqrstuvwxyz
1234567890

Helvetica Neue LT Standard

abcdefghijklmn
opqrstuvwxyz
1234567890

Tips for using additional font types

Our brand relies on the approved primary fonts. Other font styles have distinct characteristics and associations, but these should only be applied by the graphics design team where appropriate for a specific audience or format. Staff should not introduce additional fonts in council materials without prior approval.

Serif fonts – Letters with short lines appearing off the edges. These are viewed as being more formal and traditional and are best suited for print.

Sans-serif fonts – Letters without serifs which are viewed as informal and playful and best suited for digital content.

Script fonts – Resembles handwriting and often used in formal invitations but not ideal for body copy (main text).

Decorative fonts – Informal fonts viewed as original which are best suited for headlines but not body copy.

The graphics design team will use the most appropriate font for the design and audience.



Presentations

Introduction

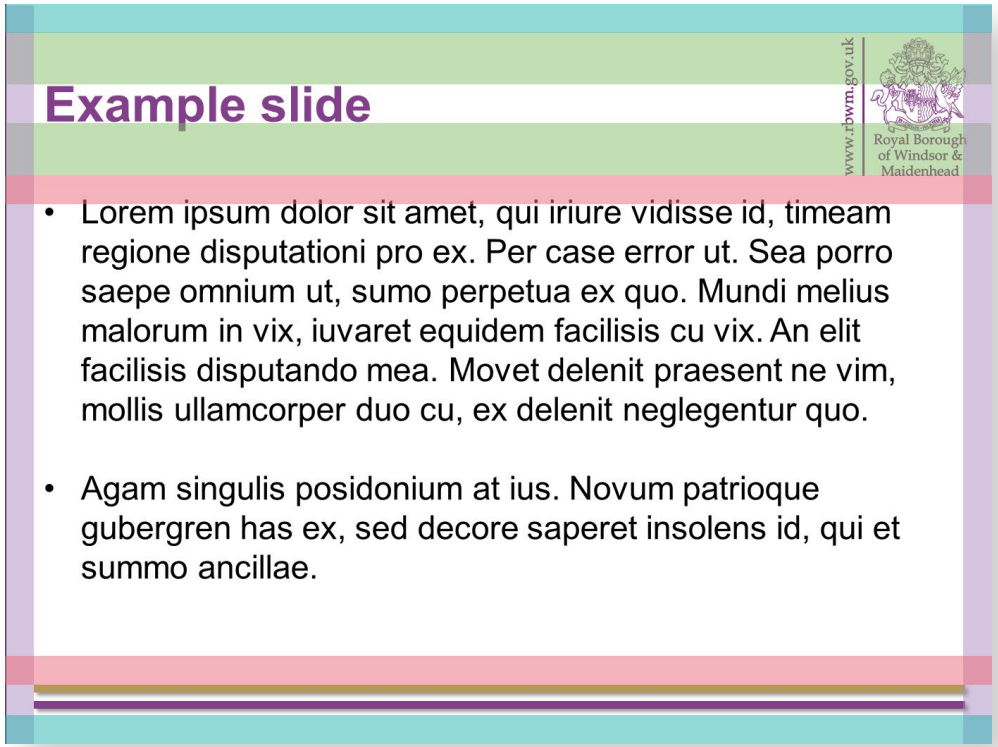
When making presentations, whether face to face, in a video or webinar, the content you display tends to be the last thing your audience will see, so professional branding plays an important part in conveying your message. The council has a Microsoft PowerPoint template readily available on sharepoint for colleagues to access and use when creating presentations. The template can be found on the communications page under ‘Quick Links’

While using this template may seem simple, there are still branding guidelines you need to adhere to. This will ensure that the content you are displaying reflects the high quality standard of the information you are presenting.



Spacing and placement of objects

A common error which users tend to make when putting together a PowerPoint is how they place the text frames and images (objects) on each slide. Often the relationship between the objects, the space around them and the edge of the slides is overlooked and can negatively impact on the quality of the content being presented. Try and create symmetry where possible when placing your graphic and text objects to create a more visually pleasing design. It's good to imagine invisible margins when placing objects help to ensure you end up with a professional looking presentation.



Visualising and marking margins on a slide helps you use white space effectively and keep objects organised. Align elements to these margins consistently to maintain a clean, cohesive design.

Helpful tips

- Do use the templates provided on sharepoint.
- Do make use of effects like drop shadow on images to give a more polished effect.
- Do use the crop tool if you have any unwanted elements on the edge of your images.
- Do make sure your font styles are the same and are consistent throughout your slides.
- Do leave a large enough space between your objects.
- Do try to resize/crop images so they are the same size for consistency.
- Do have your objects complement each other in terms of scale and positioning.

- Do not use too many animation effects; keep any you use to a bare minimum.
- Do not stretch images.
- Do not overlap the logo or purple and gold footer.



This slide's cluttered layout undermines the message and draws focus away from the main content. The partially obscured logo and cropped bottom border further detract from its professionalism.



Thoughtful object placement creates a more balanced, symmetrical layout, giving the slide a polished and professional appearance.

Additional branding

Introduction

There are some services within the council which have their own additional branding set aside from the corporate brand to reflect the unique services they offer and partnerships. These services have branding that is recognised by the council and this section outlines the additional branding rules that apply to these services. Any additional branding requests that separate from the main corporate brand should always be approved by the Communications team.

Please note that these additional branding guidelines do not apply to the corporate brand.



Additional logos

There are a number of additional logos the council officially recognises and supports and uses for different service areas. Any new logo designs must be designed or approved by the Communications team for use.

Please note that two variations of the Royal Borough logo exist solely for the purpose of marketing windsor.gov.uk.

www.windsor.gov.uk

Royal Borough of Windsor & Maidenhead

ROYAL BOROUGH OF

WINDSOR & MAIDENHEAD

WWW.WINDSOR.GOV.UK

WE
WINDSOR & ETON
TOWN PARTNERSHIP

THE ROYAL COUNTY OF
BERKSHIRE
PENSION FUND

LEISURE FOCUS

recycle
for Windsor & Maidenhead

VISIT WINDSOR

MAKE
MAIDENHEAD

THE ROYAL BOROUGH OF WINDSOR & MAIDENHEAD
Community Safety
PARTNERSHIP
It's Your Borough
Help us make it a safer place to live


THE WINDSOR GUILDHALL

My RB

achieving for children

PROJECT CENTRE

FCC Environment

VolkerHighways

conciergescheme
Royal Borough of Windsor & Maidenhead

Film Windsor & Maidenhead

COMMUNITY CHAMPIONS

VISION FOR WINDSOR

Windsor Guildhall

The Windsor Guildhall has its own colour palette, unique logo and branded materials for use:

THE WINDSOR GUILDHALL

Colour palette

‘Windsor Guildhall Red’

PANTONE SOLID COATED: 7426 C
RAL: 3027 ‘RASPBERRY RED’
CMYK: 21, 96, 58, 13

RGB: 179, 37, 70
HEX: # B32546

Gold

PANTONE SOLID COATED: 7503 C
RAL: 1001 ‘BEIGE’
CMYK: 31, 32, 62, 14

RGB: 171, 151, 103
HEX: # AA9767





Library and resident services

The council's library and resident services branding uses teal as its main colour, with purple for more formal or corporate applications. To support the breadth of events, services and activities promoted, a wider range of colours from across the spectrum may also be used where appropriate. A distinctive graphic motif, known as "the rip", is also used to help uniquely identify some library promotional materials.

Colour palette

Purple

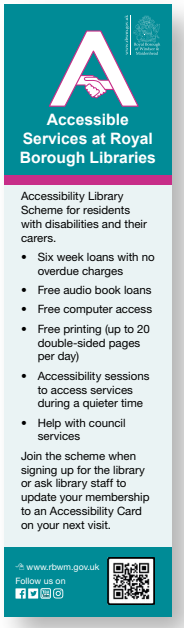
CMYK: 73, 87, 0, 0
RGB: 103, 58, 142

Teal

Pantone 321C
RAL 5021 'Water Blue'
CMYK: 76, 29, 31, 9
RGB: 50, 134, 155







Windsor Concierge Scheme

The council's Windsor Concierge scheme has its own colour palette and unique logo (which can use any of the colours from the palette below:

Colour palette

Gold

RGB: 171, 151, 103
HEX: # AB9767

Grey

RGB: 203, 199, 201
HEX: # CBC7C9

Off-Black

RGB: 35, 35, 35
HEX: # 232323





Highways and transport branding

In accordance with the council's partnerships with Volker Highways, FCC Environment and Project Centre the following guidance has been put in place to reflect that the highways and transports contracts will be delivered as a unified function.

Strapline

The strapline reflects the council's partnership message and includes the Royal Borough and main and sub-contractor logos. This should be used on digital and printed documents. The full text to be used with partner logos is:

"Royal Borough of Windsor & Maidenhead delivering Highways & Transport with"

A shortened version, with partner logos, agreed for use of uniforms is:

"Highways & Transport in partnership with"

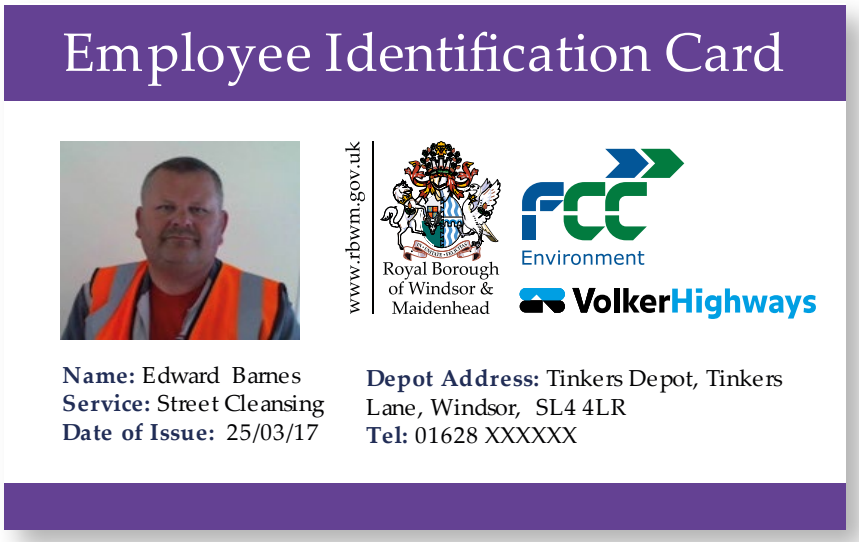
Uniform and personal protective equipment (PPE)

The agreed hi-vis branding should be used by all colleagues working across the contracts.

- Hi-vis should be orange.
- All logos are in colour.
- Font is Palatino Linotype.
- Royal Borough Ceremonial crest is to be used.



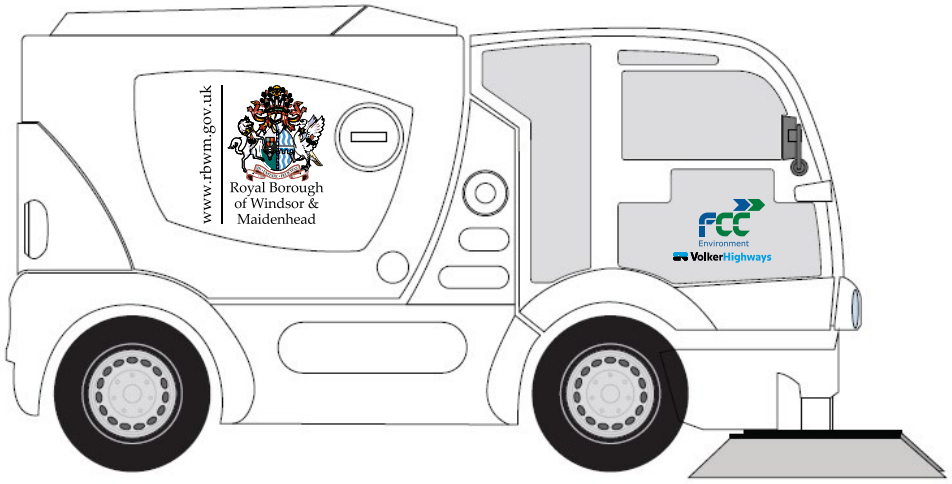
FCC employee ID cards



Vehicles and street cleansing equipment

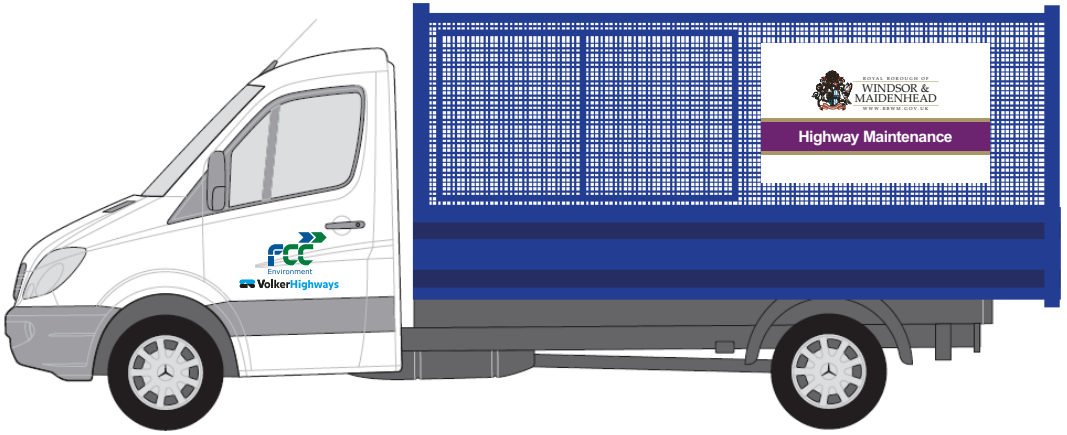
Vehicles

- The agreed design is to be used on plain white vehicles.
- Where coloured trim or plastics are used they should be either Pantone 259C or neutral in colour.
- Full colour Royal Borough website logo on the body of the vehicle.
- Partner logos on the cab.
- Street cleansing caged tipper vehicle has the partner logos in the cab as above plus a board fixed to the cage.
- The tipper boards use a special horizontal version of the Royal Borough logo.
- Tipper boards can be temporarily replaced with promotional campaign message to be agreed in advance with the Communications team for example, fly-tipping.



ROYAL BOROUGH OF
WINDSOR &
MAIDENHEAD
WWW.RBWM.GOV.UK

Highway Maintenance



Street cleansing

- Street cleansing barrows should use the same logos as the vehicles.
- Litter sacks to be clear and branded.

www.rbwm.gov.uk
Royal Borough of Windsor & Maidenhead
Environment

STREET CLEANSING

